

— WORLD CUP 2026 • DEFINING PLAYERS

FIVE PLAYERS ARE DECIDING THIS WORLD CUP.

*The performances shaping the tournament
so far.*

A 5-part breakdown

SWIPE ►►►

0101 / 05

| MESSI, ONE MORE TIME.

Six goals in the group stage. Nineteen for his career, more than anyone else in World Cup history. He is thirty-nine, on what he says is his last tournament, and defences still build their gameplan around stopping him first.



0202 / 05

| MBAPPÉ WON'T BE HELD.

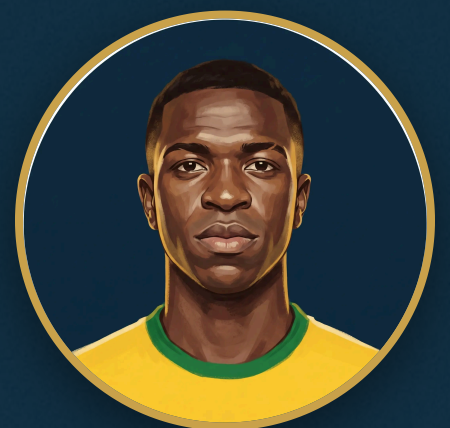
A brace against Senegal, two more past Iraq.
Four goals so far. Once he is running at a back
line, the space he opens up belongs to
everyone around him in blue.



0303 / 05

| BRAZIL'S RELEASE VALVE.

A goal against Morocco, a goal and an assist against Haiti, a brace against Scotland. When Brazil stall, Vinícius is usually the one who gets them moving again.



0404 / 05

| KOEMAN FOUND HIS STRIKER.

Handed the No.9 shirt against Sweden, Brobbey scored twice inside seventeen minutes. He holds the ball up and takes the weight of the press, which is exactly what gives the Dutch wide men room to run into.



0505 / 05

| THE NAME BEHIND THE ASSISTS.

Mbappé gets the headlines. Olise sets them up. Three assists in two matches, the most of anyone at this World Cup, and the main reason France's attack keeps finding gaps.



— THE TAKEAWAY

WHICH ONE MATTERS MOST TO **YOU?**

Tell us below. Follow @thearchv_ca for the daily World Cup archive.

◆ THE ARCHV